

EXECUTIVE FUNCTION WORKBOOK

For Adults with ADHD

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Because your brain works differently, not worse.

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WHAT ARE EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONS?

Executive functions are the brain's CEO - they manage, organize, and direct.

With ADHD, these functions are impaired - NOT because you're lazy or stupid.

1. Working Memory	Holding info in mind while using it
2. Time Management	Sensing time and planning accordingly
3. Organization	Creating and maintaining systems
4. Task Initiation	Starting tasks without procrastinating
5. Emotional Regulation	Managing emotional responses
6. Flexible Thinking	Adapting to changes and new info
7. Self-Monitoring	Tracking your own performance
8. Planning/Prioritizing	Setting goals and steps to reach them

MY EXECUTIVE FUNCTION ASSESSMENT (rate each 1-10):

1. Working Memory: ____/10
2. Time Management: ____/10
3. Organization: ____/10
4. Task Initiation: ____/10
5. Emotional Regulation: ____/10
6. Flexible Thinking: ____/10
7. Self-Monitoring: ____/10
8. Planning/Prioritizing: ____/10

WORKING MEMORY STRATEGIES

Your RAM is limited. Use external storage instead:

- Write EVERYTHING down - if it's not written, it doesn't exist
- Use a single capture system (one notebook, one app)
- Repeat information back immediately (active listening)
- Break instructions into single steps
- Use visual reminders (sticky notes, whiteboards)
- Set alarms for EVERYTHING (not just appointments)
- Create checklists for routine tasks
- Use body doubling for complex tasks

MY WORKING MEMORY HACKS:

My capture system is: _____

I will write things down by: _____

My visual reminder system: _____

How I'll remember verbal instructions: _____

TIME MANAGEMENT & TIME BLINDNESS

ADHD brains experience 'time blindness' - time is NOW or NOT NOW.

Hacks to externalize time:

- Use analog clocks (visual representation of time passing)
- Set multiple alarms: 30 min, 15 min, 5 min before events
- Time yourself doing tasks to learn how long things REALLY take
- Use the 'time tax' - add 50% more time than you think you need
- Make time visible: Time Timer, hourglass, countdown apps
- Schedule transitions (getting ready IS part of the appointment)
- Body double with timers for task sprints

TIME AUDIT - How long do these REALLY take me?

Getting ready in morning:	I think: ____ min Actual: ____ min
Commute to work:	I think: ____ min Actual: ____ min
Cooking dinner:	I think: ____ min Actual: ____ min
Grocery shopping:	I think: ____ min Actual: ____ min
Getting ready for bed:	I think: ____ min Actual: ____ min
Email/messages:	I think: ____ min Actual: ____ min

ORGANIZATION SYSTEMS

ADHD-friendly organization is VISUAL and EXTERNAL.

Key principles:

- Out of sight = out of mind. Use clear containers.
- One-step access (no lids, no closed drawers if possible)
- Landing zones: keys, wallet, phone go in ONE spot
- Labels everywhere (even if it feels excessive)
- Reduce decisions: capsule wardrobe, meal rotation
- Good enough IS good enough. Perfection kills systems.

MY ORGANIZATION PLAN:

My landing zone location:

My daily 'launch pad' items:

My filing system:

My meal planning approach:

My clothing system:

TASK INITIATION TECHNIQUES

Starting is the hardest part. These strategies lower the activation energy:

2-Minute Rule:	If it takes <2 minutes, do it NOW.
Body Doubling:	Work alongside someone (in person or virtually).
5-4-3-2-1 Launch:	Count down and START on 1. Don't think.
Shrink the Task:	Make it absurdly small. 'Open the document.'
Temptation Bundling:	Pair boring task with something enjoyable.
Environment Design:	Remove friction. Set up materials in advance.
Implementation Intention:	'When X happens, I will do Y.'
Accountability:	Tell someone what you'll do and by when.

MY TASK INITIATION TOOLKIT:

My go-to initiation strategy: _____

My body double partner: _____

My implementation intention: When _____, I will _____

Tasks I always procrastinate:

EMOTIONAL REGULATION TOOLKIT

ADHD emotions are INTENSE, QUICK, and HARD TO REGULATE.

This is part of ADHD, not a character flaw.

WHEN OVERWHELMED:

- STOP - don't react. Pause. Walk away if needed.
- Name the emotion out loud: 'I'm feeling frustrated.'
- Rate intensity 1-10. Above 7? Use body-based strategies first.
- Cold water on face/wrists (activates dive reflex, calms you)
- Box breathing: 4 in, 4 hold, 4 out, 4 hold

REJECTION SENSITIVE DYSPHORIA (RSD):

That extreme pain from perceived rejection IS real. Strategies:

- Reality check: Was I actually rejected, or am I interpreting?
- Self-compassion: 'This hurts, and that's okay.'
- Time buffer: Don't respond for 24 hours when triggered.
- Tell your person: 'I might be having an RSD moment.'

MY EMOTIONAL PATTERNS:

My biggest trigger: _____

My go-to calming strategy: _____

My RSD trigger: _____

FLEXIBLE THINKING EXERCISES

ADHD can make us rigid - stuck on one way or hyperfocused on details.

Practice cognitive flexibility:

- When Plan A fails, write 3 alternatives BEFORE getting upset
- Practice 'yes, and...' thinking instead of 'but...'
- Ask: 'What would someone else do in this situation?'
- Reframe problems as puzzles to solve
- Notice when you're black-and-white thinking (all or nothing)

FLEXIBILITY PRACTICE:

Situation 1: _____

My rigid thought: _____

Flexible alternative 1: _____

Flexible alternative 2: _____

Flexible alternative 3: _____

Situation 2: _____

My rigid thought: _____

Flexible alternative 1: _____

Flexible alternative 2: _____

Flexible alternative 3: _____

Situation 3: _____

My rigid thought: _____

Flexible alternative 1: _____

Flexible alternative 2: _____

Flexible alternative 3: _____

SELF-MONITORING CHECKLISTS

ADHD brains struggle to self-monitor. Use external check-ins:

MORNING LAUNCH CHECKLIST:

- ☐ Did I take my medication?
- ☐ Do I have my keys/wallet/phone?
- ☐ Am I dressed appropriately?
- ☐ Do I know my top 3 priorities today?
- ☐ Did I eat?
- ☐ Do I have what I need for today's tasks?

WORK CHECK-IN (set alarm every 2 hours):

- ☐ Am I on task?
- ☐ What am I supposed to be doing right now?
- ☐ Am I in a rabbit hole?
- ☐ Do I need a break?
- ☐ Am I drinking water?

END OF DAY REVIEW:

- ☐ What did I accomplish today?
- ☐ What do I need to do tomorrow?
- ☐ Is anything time-sensitive I'm forgetting?
- ☐ Did I respond to important messages?
- ☐ What went well? What needs adjusting?

PLANNING & PRIORITIZING - WORKSHEET 1

Date: _____ Week of: _____

BRAIN DUMP (everything on your mind - no order):

NOW categorize using Eisenhower Matrix:

URGENT + IMPORTANT (Do first):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

IMPORTANT, NOT URGENT (Schedule):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Delegate/Minimize):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

NOT URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Eliminate):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY TOP 3 FOR TODAY:

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

PLANNING & PRIORITIZING - WORKSHEET 2

Date: _____ Week of: _____

BRAIN DUMP (everything on your mind - no order):

NOW categorize using Eisenhower Matrix:

URGENT + IMPORTANT (Do first):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

IMPORTANT, NOT URGENT (Schedule):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Delegate/Minimize):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

NOT URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Eliminate):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY TOP 3 FOR TODAY:

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

PLANNING & PRIORITIZING - WORKSHEET 3

Date: _____ Week of: _____

BRAIN DUMP (everything on your mind - no order):

NOW categorize using Eisenhower Matrix:

URGENT + IMPORTANT (Do first):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

IMPORTANT, NOT URGENT (Schedule):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Delegate/Minimize):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

NOT URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Eliminate):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY TOP 3 FOR TODAY:

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

PLANNING & PRIORITIZING - WORKSHEET 4

Date: _____ Week of: _____

BRAIN DUMP (everything on your mind - no order):

NOW categorize using Eisenhower Matrix:

URGENT + IMPORTANT (Do first):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

IMPORTANT, NOT URGENT (Schedule):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Delegate/Minimize):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

NOT URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Eliminate):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY TOP 3 FOR TODAY:

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

PLANNING & PRIORITIZING - WORKSHEET 5

Date: _____ Week of: _____

BRAIN DUMP (everything on your mind - no order):

NOW categorize using Eisenhower Matrix:

URGENT + IMPORTANT (Do first):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

IMPORTANT, NOT URGENT (Schedule):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Delegate/Minimize):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

NOT URGENT, NOT IMPORTANT (Eliminate):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY TOP 3 FOR TODAY:

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

GOAL BREAKDOWN TEMPLATE 1

MY GOAL: _____

Deadline: _____ Why this matters to me: _____

BREAK IT DOWN (smallest possible steps):

☐ Step 1: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 2: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 3: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 4: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 5: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 6: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 7: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 8: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 9: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 10: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 11: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 12: _____ By: _____

What might get in the way? _____

My plan for obstacles: _____

Accountability partner: _____

Reward when complete: _____

GOAL BREAKDOWN TEMPLATE 2

MY GOAL: _____

Deadline: _____ Why this matters to me: _____

BREAK IT DOWN (smallest possible steps):

☐ Step 1: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 2: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 3: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 4: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 5: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 6: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 7: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 8: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 9: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 10: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 11: _____ By: _____

☐ Step 12: _____ By: _____

What might get in the way? _____

My plan for obstacles: _____

Accountability partner: _____

Reward when complete: _____

GOAL BREAKDOWN TEMPLATE 3

MY GOAL: _____

Deadline: _____ Why this matters to me: _____

BREAK IT DOWN (smallest possible steps):

- ☐ Step 1: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 2: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 3: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 4: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 5: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 6: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 7: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 8: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 9: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 10: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 11: _____ By: _____
- ☐ Step 12: _____ By: _____

What might get in the way? _____

My plan for obstacles: _____

Accountability partner: _____

Reward when complete: _____

WEEKLY EF PRACTICE LOG - WEEK 1

Date range: _____

Mon	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Tue	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wed	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Thu	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Fri	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sat	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sun	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wins this week:

Challenges:

Adjustments for next week:

WEEKLY EF PRACTICE LOG - WEEK 2

Date range: _____

Mon	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Tue	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wed	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Thu	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Fri	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sat	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sun	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wins this week:

Challenges:

Adjustments for next week:

WEEKLY EF PRACTICE LOG - WEEK 3

Date range: _____

Mon	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Tue	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wed	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Thu	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Fri	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sat	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sun	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wins this week:

Challenges:

Adjustments for next week:

WEEKLY EF PRACTICE LOG - WEEK 4

Date range: _____

Mon	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Tue	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wed	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Thu	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Fri	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
------------	---------------------------	----------------------	--------------

Sat	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sun	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
------------	---------------------------	----------------------	--------------

Wins this week:

Challenges:

Adjustments for next week:

WEEKLY EF PRACTICE LOG - WEEK 5

Date range: _____

Mon	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Tue	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wed	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Thu	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
------------	---------------------------	----------------------	--------------

Fri	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
------------	---------------------------	----------------------	--------------

Sat	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Sun	EF skill practiced: _____	Strategy used: _____	Success? Y/N
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Wins this week:

Challenges:

Adjustments for next week:

MY PERSONALIZED EF STRATEGY PLAN

Working Memory:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

Time Management:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

Organization:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

Task Initiation:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

Emotional Regulation:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

Flexible Thinking:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

Self-Monitoring:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

Planning:

My strategy: _____

Tool/app I'll use: _____

ADHD-FRIENDLY ROUTINES

Morning Routine (keep it SHORT - max 5 steps):

1. _____ Time: _____ min
2. _____ Time: _____ min
3. _____ Time: _____ min
4. _____ Time: _____ min
5. _____ Time: _____ min

Evening Routine (set tomorrow up for success):

1. _____ Time: _____ min
2. _____ Time: _____ min
3. _____ Time: _____ min
4. _____ Time: _____ min
5. _____ Time: _____ min

MY ADHD STRENGTHS

ADHD gives you SUPERPOWERS. Own them:

- * Hyperfocus (when engaged, you're unstoppable)
- * Creativity (divergent thinking is your default)
- * Resilience (you've overcome more than most)
- * Energy/enthusiasm (when interested, you light up a room)
- * Crisis management (you thrive under pressure)
- * Big-picture thinking (connecting dots others miss)

My personal ADHD superpowers:
